Mahatma Gandhi University, Kottayam MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular/Improvement/Reappearance Examination April 2026 **Q.P. Code 25901785**

Second Semester Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) – MG2DSCSWK100 Philosophical Foundations of Social Work

Part A Short Answer any 5 questions Each question carries 2 marks

1. Define micro-level social work with an example. • **Definition:** Micro-level social work focuses on helping **individuals, families, or small groups** to address personal and social problems through direct interaction. • **Example:** A social worker providing counselling to a person dealing with depression or helping a family resolve conflicts.	[K] / [CO1]
2. Define integrity • **Meaning:** Integrity refers to **honesty, transparency, and strong moral principles** in professional practice. • **Practice:** Social workers act ethically, avoid deception, and maintain consistency between their values and actions.	[K] / [CO2]
3. Explain the value of dignity and self-determination in brief. • **Dignity:** Every individual deserves **respect and worth**, regardless of their background or condition. • **Self-determination:** Clients have the **right to make their own choices and decisions** without undue interference.	[U] / [CO2]
4. Identify a response to client disclosure of illegal acts. • **Maintain professionalism:** Listen without judgment and ensure a supportive environment. • **Follow ethical/legal limits:** Maintain confidentiality but report if there is **risk of harm to self or others** or legal obligation.	[U] / [CO2]
5. List two components of professional responsibility. • **Accountability:** Being responsible for one's actions and decisions in practice. • **Competence:** Maintaining proper knowledge, skills, and continuous professional development.	[K] / [CO3
6. Define confidentiality and informed consent in the context of social work practice • **Confidentiality:** Protecting client information and not sharing it without permission (except in legal/ethical exceptions). • **Informed consent:** Ensuring clients **fully understand services, risks, and rights** before agreeing to participate.	] [K] / [CO
7. Discuss the meaning of social justice • **Equality and fairness:** Ensuring equal rights, opportunities, and access to resources for all individuals. • **Advocacy:** Social workers work to reduce inequality, discrimination, and oppression in society.	[U] / [CO4]

Part B Short Essay Answer any 4 questions- Each question carries 5 marks

8. Explain how empathy enhances the effectiveness of a social worker. a) Builds **trust and rapport** with clients. b) Helps in **better understanding** clients' feelings and situations. c) Encourages **open communication** and client participation. d) Improves **accurate assessment** of problems and needs. e) Leads to **more effective interventions** and positive outcomes.	[U] / [CO2]
9. Describe how personal values can help social workers manage stress ethically. a) Provide a **moral framework** for handling difficult situations. b) Help maintain **professional boundaries** and avoid burnout. c) Encourage **self-reflection** and emotional control. d) Promote **ethical decision-making** even under pressure. e) Support **resilience and commitment** to professional duties.	[U] / [CO4]
10. Analyse how values relating to the individual influence ethical decision making in social work. a) Respect for **individual autonomy** guides decisions. b) Promotes **non-judgmental attitudes** toward clients. c) Ensures **fair and unbiased treatment**. d) Encourages **cultural sensitivity** and respect for diversity. e) Helps balance **client needs with professional ethics**.	[An] / [CO4
11. Describe how the value of dignity and worth of the person influences ethical decisions.	[U] /

a) Ensures **respectful treatment** of all clients. b) Prevents **discrimination and stigmatization**. c) Promotes **client participation** in decision-making. d) Supports **empowerment and self-confidence** of clients. e) Guides ethical actions that **protect human rights**.	[CO5
12. List the core ethical principles of social work a) **Service** – helping people in need. b) **Social justice** – challenging injustice. c) **Dignity and worth of the person**. d) **Importance of human relationships**. e) **Integrity and competence**.	[K] / [CO4
13. Explain the significance of beneficence in ethical social work. a) Focuses on **doing good and promoting well-being**. b) Encourages actions that **benefit the client**. c) Helps prevent **harm or exploitation**. d) Guides **responsible and caring interventions**. e) Strengthens **trust in the social worker-client relationship**.	[U] / [CO2
14. Explain an ethical dilemma you may face when receiving a gift from a client. a) May create **boundary issues** in the professional relationship. b) Risk of **favoritism or bias** in service delivery. c) Could affect **objectivity and professional judgment**. d) Cultural factors may make refusal **sensitive or disrespectful**. e) Requires following **ethical guidelines and agency policy** (e.g., politely declining or documenting).	[U] / [CO2

Part C Essay Answer any 2 questions Each question carries 10 marks

15. Critically examine the core philosophical foundations and values of social work. How do these influence ethical practice in real-world settings? a) **Human dignity and worth** – Every individual is respected, guiding non-discriminatory practice. b) **Social justice** – Focus on reducing inequality and advocating for marginalized groups. c) **Service orientation** – Commitment to helping people in need. d) **Human rights perspective** – Upholds fundamental rights in all interventions. e) **Holistic approach** – Considers biological, psychological, and social factors. f) **Empowerment** – Encourages client participation and self-reliance. g) **Respect for diversity** – Promotes culturally sensitive practice. h) **Professional integrity** – Ensures honesty and ethical conduct. i) **Importance of relationships** – Builds trust and effective helping processes. j) **Influence on practice** – These values guide decision-making, ensure ethical interventions, and help resolve dilemmas in real-world situations.	[E] / [CO6
16. Analyse the ethical risks and responsibilities of using technology and social media in social work. a) **Confidentiality risks** – Possibility of data breaches or unauthorized access. b) **Privacy concerns** – Clients' personal information may be exposed online. c) **Boundary issues** – Blurring of professional and personal relationships. d) **Informed consent** – Clients must understand digital communication risks. e) **Digital divide** – Unequal access to technology may exclude some clients. f) **Professional conduct** – Maintaining appropriate behavior on social media. g) **Record keeping** – Secure storage and documentation of digital interactions. h) **Misinformation** – Risk of sharing inaccurate or harmful information. i) **Legal compliance** – Adhering to laws and ethical codes regarding data use. j) **Responsibility** – Social workers must use technology ethically to enhance services while minimizing	[An] / [CO3
17. Explain the principles of social work a) **Acceptance** – Accepting clients without judgment. b) **Individualization** – Recognizing each client's uniqueness. c) **Self-determination** – Respecting clients' right to make decisions. d) **Confidentiality** – Protecting client information. e) **Non-judgmental attitude** – Avoiding bias and prejudice. f) **Controlled emotional involvement** – Maintaining professional balance. g) **Purposeful expression of feelings** – Allowing clients to express emotions.	[K] / [CO4]

h) **Professional relationship** – Building trust and respect. i) **Accountability** – Being responsible for professional actions. j) **Social justice** – Promoting fairness and equality in society.	
18. Critically evaluate the ethical principles embedded in Rights-Based and Developmental models a) **Rights-Based model** emphasizes **human rights, equality, and justice**. b) Promotes **empowerment and participation** of marginalized groups. c) Ensures **accountability of institutions and governments**. d) Risk: May be **difficult to implement** in resource-poor settings. e) Sometimes leads to **conflict with cultural norms**. f) **Developmental model** focuses on **growth, capacity-building, and sustainability**. g) Encourages **self-reliance and long-term solutions**. h) Risk: May **overlook immediate needs** of vulnerable populations. i) Ethical strength: Balances **individual and community development**. j) Both models complement each other—ethical practice requires integrating **rights protection with sustainable development**	[E] / [CO4